1872–1957



“WHEN WE DEMAND SEPARATION WE DO NOT MEAN, AND WE CANNOT MEAN THAT WE CUT AWAY FROM OUR BRETHREN ALTOGETHER. SEPARATION IS ONLY FOR THE SAKE OF ADMINISTRATIVE CONVENIENCE AND DEVELOPMENT OF EACH AREA. ALL OTHER BONDS OF BUSINESS, FRIENDSHIP AND RELATIONSHIP REMAIN INTACT.”

Tanguturi Prakasam Pantulu was a lawyer and a member of the Constituent Assembly and the Congress. A strong advocate of workers’ rights and the rights of the rural poor, he was renowned for his courage, generosity and sense of fairness. He felt that the provinces of new India should be reorganized along linguistic lines—a demand the Congress had supported for years but done little to fulfil after 1947. Prakasam was among the leaders of a movement for a separate state for Telugu-speaking people. After several protests and some violent rioting, the central government relented, and a portion of the old Madras State was carved out to create Andhra state in 1953.

DOES INDIA HAVE A NATIONAL LANGUAGE?